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Set to be inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame next year, renowned tennis broadcaster **Mary Carillo** reflects on a career that reshaped how the sport is told.



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Insightful and probing, yet sensitive and humorous, Mary Carillo was acclaimed as the 'Best Announcer on Television' by *World Tennis* magazine in 1990 and by *Tennis* magazine from 1989–92. *Tennis* included Carillo, then broadcasting the sport for *ESPN* and *CBS*, as the only media star in its '20 Most Powerful People in Tennis' article in 1992.

In its encomium to Carillo and her fast-growing popularity, *Tennis* wrote, "With just the right blend of intelligence and irreverence, the game's liveliest voice has become tennis' voice of authority to those whose only exposure to the game is through TV."

If Carillo reminds many tennis fans of Bud Collins, the iconic American journalist and TV commentator, it's no accident. "His writing, his keen observations, and his sense of fun formed all my own ideas about how to cover tennis," Carillo told me in 2015. Like the eclectic, entertaining Collins, she spread her storytelling wings to broadcast other events beyond tennis at 16 Summer and Winter Olympic Games, including swimming, skiing, athletics, and badminton.

In recent years, the versatile Carillo has covered *The National*

Dog Show for *NBC*, which airs on Thanksgiving Day and regularly draws 20 million viewers.

As a correspondent for *HBO's Real Sports*, Carillo earned four Emmy Awards, including two for Olympic coverage, and three Peabody Awards, including two for *HBO* documentaries — *Dare To Compete: The Struggle of Women in Sports* and *Billie Jean King: Portrait of a Pioneer*. In 2018, she was inducted into the Sports Broadcasting Hall of Fame.

Now, Carillo — arguably the most distinguished women's tennis broadcaster in history — will be enshrined in the International Tennis Hall of Fame in the Contributor category during the Induction Celebration at Newport, Rhode